Chapter 18: First Year of Kābul

1 In the Turkī tribes, applying razor to the face for the first time is celebrated with a great fervour. Babur's miserable circumstances would not admit of this. (John Leyden, 1886)

> The text is ambiguous here, reading either that Sūkh was left or that Aīlāq-yīlāq was reached in Muḥarram. As the birthday was on the 8th, the journey very arduous and, for a party mostly on foot, slow, it seems safest to suppose that the start was made from Sūkh at the end of AH 909. and not in Muḥarram, AH 910. (Beveridge, 1922)

2 The ālāchūq, a tent of flexible poles, covered with felt, may be the *khargāh* (kibitka); Persian chādar seems to represent *Turkī āq awī*, white house.

3 Qur'an 3.26 (Sale, 1734)

4 Canopus is known as Suhail in Afghānistān and is one of the most clearly seen star in Afghānistān. The south gets its name from it, as it is never called Janūb but Suhail. The rising of Suhail marks one of their seasons (John Leyden, 1886). The honour attached to this star is due to its seeming to rise out of Arabia Felix.

5 Bodies (*būlāks*) were probably a group of a thousand fighter Turki Mīng.

6 This part of Persian manuscript could not be translated and hence the excerpt has been put directly from Annette Susannah Beveridge (Ghāzī, 1922).

7 Kāfirwash; they were Kāfirs converted to Muḥammadanism.

8 West might be more exact, since some of the group are a little north, others a little south of the latitude of Kābul.

9 i.e. the year now in writing. The account of the expedition, Bābur's first into Hindustan, begins on f. 145.

10 i.e. the countries groupable as Khurāsān